Eduardo Santander-Ramírez

Head of Institutional Research, Universidad Gabriela Mistral
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Education

2026 **Ph.D. in Higher and Postsecondary Education**, Teachers College, Columbia University, New York, NY
Dissertation: *From Balance Sheets to Student Outcomes: Institutional Finances and First-Year Retention in Chilean Higher Education, 2017–2024.*

2026 **M.Phil. in Organization and Leadership** (Higher and Postsecondary Education), Columbia University, New York, NY

2023 **M.A. in Higher and Postsecondary Education**, Teachers College, Columbia University, New York, NY

2015 **M.A. in Sociology** (*Magíster en Sociología*), Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

2012 **B.A. in Sociology** (*Licenciatura*; professional title of Sociologist, 2015), Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile. Minors in Political Science and in Education

Additional Training

2022 Certificate in Quality Assurance in Higher Education, Universidad de Chile

Research Interests

Higher education policy and finance; sociology of finance and of university organizations; student success and first-year retention; equity in postsecondary systems; quantitative policy analysis and program evaluation; comparative higher education, with a focus on Latin America.

Professional Appointments

2026–present **Head of Institutional Research**, Universidad Gabriela Mistral, Santiago, Chile. Strategic information, performance indicators, and support for accreditation and planning.

2026 **Adjunct Instructor** (graduate), Universidad Diego Portales, Santiago, Chile. See Teaching.

2023–2024 **Student Life Coordinator**, School of Professional Studies, Columbia University, New York, NY. Student programming and budget management.

2020–2022 **Academic Progression Analyst**, Universidad Diego Portales, Santiago, Chile. Studies of academic progression and first-year retention; evaluation of equity programs.

2018–2019 **Senior Accreditation Analyst**, Universidad de las Américas, Santiago, Chile. Institutional and program accreditation processes before Chile's National Accreditation Commission (CNA).

2017–2019 **Institutional Research Analyst**, Universidad Finis Terrae, Santiago, Chile. Institutional studies and data-driven organizational change for accreditation.

Publications

Also published as *Santander, E.* Indexing and quartile shown in brackets.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

[9] **Santander-Ramírez, E.** (2026). The other side of free: Institutional finance and the limits of demand-side policy in Chilean higher education. *Higher Education Policy*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1057/s41307-026-00489-5 [WoS Q1]

[8] **Santander, E.** (2026). Lost in translation: How higher education studies conflates Latinx and international Latin American experiences through misplaced racialization. *Journal of Comparative & International Higher Education, 18*(5). https://digitalcommons.lib.uconn.edu/jcihe/vol18/iss5

[7] **Santander-Ramírez, E.** (2026). Growth in doctoral-qualified professoriate in Chilean higher education (2008–2024): A hierarchical linear growth model. *Pensamiento Educativo, 63*(2), 1–14. [Scopus Q3]

[6] **Santander, E.**, Fariña, J., & Sotomayor, P. (2026). Unpacking the black box of first-year college attainment: Evidence from a flagship regional university in Chile. *Education Policy Analysis Archives, 34*. https://doi.org/10.14507/epaa.34.8997 [Scopus Q2]

[5] **Santander-Ramírez, E.**, Avendaño Casassas, M., & Soto de la Cruz, P. (2022). Does parents' socioeconomic status determine their willingness to participate in their offspring's education? A study in students who attend primary education in Chile. *Revista Andina de Educación, 6*(1), Article 000613.

[4] **Santander-Ramírez, E.**, Muñoz, Y., Fernández, M. J., & Soto de la Cruz, P. (2022). Does a greater number of migrant children make the practices of early childhood educators more inclusive? A case study in public kindergartens in Chile. *Revista Boliviana de Educación, 4*(7), 48–65.

[3] **Santander-Ramírez, E.**, Avendaño Casassas, M., Parada, S., & Soto de la Cruz, P. (2022). Implicit learning representations and pedagogical practice of early childhood teacher educators: A case study in a private Catholic university in Chile. *Revista Peruana de Investigación Educativa, 14*(16), 9–35.

[2] Valdebenito-Acosta, F., Hasbún-Mancilla, J., **Santander-Ramírez, E.**, & Gallardo, P. (2021). Nursing technicians in Chile: A competency-based analysis of training profiles. *Revista Médica de Chile, 149*(6), 829–835. [Scopus Q4]

[1] **Santander-Ramírez, E.**, Berríos, Ll., Soto de la Cruz, P., & Avendaño, M. (2019). Parents' socialization of values in contemporary Chile: How do social class and parents' religion shape how they raise their children? *Apuntes, 87*, 65–86. [Scopus Q2]

Manuscripts Under Review

Santander, E. Lever or marker? Institutional financial condition and first-year retention in Chilean higher education, 2017–2024. *Higher Education*.

Santander, E., & Leihy, P. Accreditation, financial distress, and institutional exit in Chilean higher education, 2017–2024. *Quality Assurance in Education*.

Santander, E. When revenue falls, who absorbs the cut? Compensation adjustment dynamics in Chilean higher education, 2017–2024. *Financial Accountability & Management*.

Santander, E. Who captures free tuition? Institutional selectivity, per-student subsidies, and the distributive limits of Chile's *Gratuidad* policy. *Journal of Tertiary Education and Management*.

Santander, E. Counting the first year: Student success outcomes as economization and commensuration. *Studies in Higher Education*.

Santander, E. Converging on a template: Mimetic isomorphism in Chilean university research incentives. *Policy Reviews in Higher Education*.

Santander, E. Two roads from the institution to the student: A dual-pathway framework for organizational influence on college persistence. *Journal of Hispanic Higher Education*.

Santander, E. Scoring without reasons: Administrative immunization and borrowed excellence in Chile's Becas Chile scholarship. *Minerva*.

Conference Presentations

[3] **Santander, E.** (2026, October 27–29). ¿Quién paga la cuenta? *Administrative bloat* y ajuste salarial en la educación superior chilena, 2017–2024 [Who pays the bill? Administrative bloat and salary adjustment in Chilean higher education, 2017–2024]. *Séptimo Congreso Interdisciplinario de Investigación en Educación (CIIE 2026)*, Santiago, Chile.

[2] **Santander, E.** (2025). Unpacking the black box of first-year college attainment: Evidence from a flagship regional university in Chile. *Comparative and International Education Society (CIES) Annual Conference*, Chicago, IL.

[1] **Santander, E.** (2024). Progress over retention: Understanding drivers of credit attainment in the first college year in a flagship regional university in Chile. *Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP), 49th Annual Conference*, Baltimore, MD.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

2024, 2025	Provost's Grant for Conference Presentation & Professional Development, Teachers College, Columbia University
2024	Dean's Student Research Award, Teachers College, Columbia University
2024	Anna Neumann Supporting Student Research Award (USD 1,600), Teachers College, Columbia University
2023	Roland DeLano Rinsland Scholar (USD 15,000), Teachers College, Columbia University
2022, 2024	ANID Scholarship for Master's (2022) and Doctoral (2024) Studies Abroad, full scholarship, Advanced Human Capital Program, Government of Chile
2014	CONICYT National Graduate Scholarship, full scholarship, Government of Chile
2014	Graduate Studies Scholarship, Fundación Volcán Calbuco
2010, 2011	Award for Highest Grade Point Average, School of Sociology, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

Teaching

Teaching areas: quantitative methods and statistics; higher education policy and finance; economic management of educational institutions; sociology of education; student success.

Instructor of Record — Graduate

2026 *Economic Management in Educational Institutions*, M.A. in Education. Universidad Diego Portales

2026 *The Politics of Research Methods*, M.A. in Research Methods. Universidad Diego Portales

2018 *Quantitative Research Methodology*, M.A. in Education. Universidad Santo Tomás

Instructor of Record — Undergraduate

2020 *Statistics and Quantitative Methodology*, Faculty of Humanities. Universidad Mayor

2017–2018 *Statistics IV*; *Social Surveys*, Family Sciences program. Universidad Finis Terrae

2015–2020 *Foundations of Statistics*; *Quantitative Research Methodology*, Psychology program. Universidad UNIACC

Teaching Assistance

2023–2024 Course Assistant, *The American College Student* (graduate course, Dr. Staci Ripkey). Teachers College, Columbia University

Thesis Supervision

2026 Master's thesis advisor: *Evaluación del PACE en la carrera de Medicina Veterinaria, Universidad Católica de Temuco* [Evaluation of the PACE program in the Veterinary Medicine degree, Universidad Católica de Temuco]. M.A. in Education, Universidad Gabriela Mistral

Professional Service

2023–present Editorial Associate, *Teachers College Record*, Columbia University

Skills and Languages

Methods Regression, hierarchical linear (HLM) and growth models, institutional panel data, program evaluation, policy analysis

Software Stata and SPSS (advanced), HLM, R (intermediate), NVivo, Atlas.ti

Languages Spanish (native)
English (fluent, C1): IELTS, band 8, 2021
French (upper-intermediate, B2): *Diplôme d'études en langue française* (DELF B2), French Ministry of National Education, 2018

References

Available upon request.

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